ABCC 2027 Role Playbooks — Team HSBI

Audience: the four HSBI competitors and the coach. **Scope:** who does what, minute by minute, in the timed rounds, plus our generative-AI operating procedure and the prep-room kit. Facts follow the 2025 Event Guide baseline in `01-competition/facts_and_rules.md`; re-verify against the 2027 rules package when published.

Context in one paragraph. The fifth annual ABCC runs 18–22 February 2027 at the Drake Centre, Asper School of Business, Winnipeg — nine teams of four. Three scored rounds: the **prepared case** (25 %; 25-minute presentation + 15-minute Q&A, submitted as .pptx by e-mail; late submissions go to the bottom of the pool), the **boardroom case** (30 %; 4-hour on-site prep, then a **protected 3-minute recommendation on one summary slide** with appendices blocked, followed by a **22-minute discussion** with appendices accessible; judges receive our **one-page black-and-white executive brief** in advance), and the **traditional case** (45 %; 3-hour on-site prep, 20-minute presentation + 10-minute Q&A). The top three reach a final with **frozen decks** (20 + 15); ties break on the higher traditional-case score — **traditional day is where the competition is won** (2025 pattern put it on Saturday; the Thu–Mon 2027 footprint most likely puts it on Sunday — confirm with the 2027 guide). Every member must speak in every round (in the boardroom, during the discussion). During on-site prep: internet, university databases, file sharing and **generative AI are allowed**; one laptop per student; no phones or smartwatches; no coach or outside contact after release; identifying our school to a judge means disqualification. Timing cards: yellow at 5 minutes, red at 1.

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The shared team clock

All four playbooks run on the same six phases so hand-offs are predictable. Slots are staggered and **late arrival earns no extra time**; the clock starts the second the case is handed over.

Phase	Traditional (3 h)	Boardroom (4 h)	Team output at gate
P1 Read & frame	0:00–0:20	0:00–0:25	Everyone has read; key facts logged
P2 Align & decide	0:20–0:40	0:25–0:55	One-sentence recommendation locked
P3 Analysis sprint	0:40–1:40	0:55–2:15	Model, evidence, concept detail done
P4 Build	1:40–2:25	2:15–3:15	Deck (+ brief) assembled in template
P5 Verify & rehearse	2:25–2:50	3:15–3:45	Numbers audited; Q&A grid filled; run-through
P6 Lockdown & USB	2:50–3:00	3:45–4:00	Files named, saved to provided USB, verified

Two hard gates: the direction locked at P2 is reopened only by the strategist (at an announced 10-minute cost), and a **number freeze** starts at P6 — after it, nothing new goes on a slide.

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1. Finance lead

Mission. Own every number the team shows or says. The heaviest rubric line, *Implementation & resources* (2.5×), explicitly asks for financial and resource considerations, and *Analysis* (2.0×) demands quantitative substantiation — so this role converts every idea into costs, benefits, payback and a funded plan. Nothing financial reaches a slide unless this role produced or verified it.

Owned artifacts per round.

Round	Artifacts
Prepared (25 %)	Full financial model workbook; impact exhibit (payback/NPV); costed implementation budget; sensitivity table
Boardroom (30 %)	The three headline figures on the single summary slide; financial paragraph of the one-page brief; 3–5 financial appendix slides; costed resourcing plan
Traditional (45 %)	Quantified-impact slide; implementation budget and resourcing slide; financial appendices; assumptions register
Final	Nothing new (decks frozen) — total command of every number for the 15-minute Q&A

Minute-map.

Phase	Traditional (3 h)	Boardroom (4 h)
P1	Read financial exhibits first; log every given figure into the assumptions register	Same, with 5 extra minutes on the client's baseline economics
P2	Two-minute "size of the prize" estimate per option to inform the vote	Same; flag which option we can credibly cost in 4 hours
P3	Build the model from the prebuilt shell: baseline, option economics, implementation costs; push interim outputs to the strategist	Same, deeper: add sensitivity and a funding/resourcing view for the brief
P4	Turn the model into 2–3 slides (impact, budget, sensitivity); supply exec-summary numbers	Deliver max three headline figures for the summary slide; write the brief's financial lines; build the financial appendix
P5	**Number audit:** recompute every displayed figure from source; run the AI math-check lane; brief the team on the three numbers judges will attack	Same, plus rehearse a "walk me through your model" appendix path for the discussion
P6	Freeze the assumptions register; tie out final deck against the workbook	Same, plus confirm brief tables read in black-and-white print

Pre-competition drills. (1) Model-shell speed drill: blank prebuilt shell to working option economics in 45 minutes. (2) Mental-math and clean-rounding drill for live Q&A. (3) Rebuild the numbers for a past case (e.g., Access Credit Union 2026) end-to-end. (4) Sensitivity one-pager in 10 minutes. (5) Coach-led assumption gauntlet: defend every input for 15 minutes.

Failure modes and countermeasures.

- **Over-modeling.** The model becomes an end in itself. → Hard gate: slide-ready outputs by end of P3; the strategist may call "good enough" and it stands.
- **Orphan numbers.** Slide edits drift from the model. → One workbook is the single source of truth; number freeze at P6 with a final tie-out.
- **False precision.** "€1,247,332" invites attack. → Round aggressively, show ranges, label assumptions.
- **Freezing on an assumption challenge.** → The assumptions register carries a rationale and a sensitivity for each input: "at half our uptake, payback moves from 18 to 30 months — the recommendation holds."

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2. Innovation lead

Mission. Own the distinctiveness and concreteness of the recommendation. *Recommendation* weighs 2.0× and nine teams see the same case; recent clients explicitly wanted boldness (Jazz Winnipeg: a "radical new operational idea"; Coal & Canary: premium to luxury; Access Credit Union: youth-engaging service innovations). Generate wide, kill fast, make the survivor vivid and implementable.

Owned artifacts per round.

Round	Artifacts
Prepared (25 %)	Option tree with kill log; concept slides (what it is, why this client, why now); differentiation story; pilot design
Boardroom (30 %)	The recommendation's core wording and label on the summary slide; counterargument prep sheet for the discussion; concept appendix
Traditional (45 %)	Concept and "why this wins" slide; alternatives-considered slide; pilot/rollout design input

Round	Artifacts
Final	Sharpened articulation; rehearsed answers to every “why not X?”

Minute-map.

Phase	Traditional (3 h)	Boardroom (4 h)
P1	Read for customer, market and constraint signals; draft 5–7 option stubs	Same, plus note what the client tried before (recent boardroom panels included a company representative)
P2	Pitch each stub in 30 seconds; run the kill; lock direction with the strategist	Same, plus draft the one-sentence recommendation for the protected 3 minutes
P3	Make the idea concrete: features, customer journey, differentiation; pull precedent with the CS lead; feed sizing inputs to finance	Same, deeper: define the pilot and the “day one” experience
P4	Build concept and alternatives-considered slides (considered alternatives score under *Analysis*)	Own the recommendation wording on the summary slide; build the concept appendix
P5	Red-team own idea via the AI counterargument lane; script “why not the obvious alternative?” answers	Same, tuned for the interactive 22-minute discussion
P6	Final coherence read: does every slide serve the idea’s story?	Same

Pre-competition drills. (1) Ten ideas in ten minutes, weekly. (2) Kill-criteria drill: impact/feasibility/fit screen in 5 minutes. (3) Analogy transfer: adapt a proven model from an adjacent industry in 15 minutes. (4) “So what?” chains: any feature to client benefit in three steps. (5) Regenerate options for past ABCC cases; compare against what strong teams chose.

Failure modes and countermeasures.

- **Falling in love with idea #1.** → Minimum five options and a written kill log before P2 lock — no exceptions.
- **Clever but unimplementable.** The heaviest rubric line is implementation (2.5×). → Every concept element must map to a resourced step in the strategist’s plan; unmappable elements are cut or parked as “phase 2”.
- **Reopening the decision mid-build.** → Only the strategist can reopen, at an announced 10-minute cost.
- **A generic answer eight other teams will give.** → P3 differentiation check: “Which two teams will say exactly this — and what is our twist?”

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3. CS & analytics lead

Mission. Own the evidence and the machinery: fastest researcher, data wrangler, chart builder, deck mechanic, and designated AI operator. *Analysis* (2.0×) rewards research plus quantitative and qualitative rigor; this role also owns file compliance (.pptx only, exact file names such as “[Team Name] Traditional Case”, USB handover at the fixed pickup time) so nobody else thinks about mechanics.

Owned artifacts per round.

Round	Artifacts
Prepared (25 %)	Research pack with source log; data exhibits and charts; master deck file; the on-time submission e-mail (“[Team Name] Prepared Case”)
Boardroom (30 %)	Numbered appendix map so any judge question reaches its appendix in seconds; charts for slide and brief; USB save
Traditional (45 %)	Benchmark table with sources; exhibits; master deck; USB save under the exact required file name
Final	Printed Q&A grid and appendix map (deck edits are impossible)

Minute-map.

Phase	Traditional (3 h)	Boardroom (4 h)
P1	Stand up the workspace: shared files, prebuilt neutral template open, visible timer; extract case exhibit data into a working sheet	Same
P2	Rapid market/benchmark scan to inform the vote; open the source log	Same
P3	On-demand research sprints (customer stats, comparables) — everything into the source log; build charts for finance and innovation; operate the team AI lane per the SOP below	Same, plus one deeper data pull the 3-hour round cannot afford
P4	Rolling deck merge: pull everyone's slides into the template, fix formatting, number the appendices	Same, plus lay out the one-page brief in black-and-white and print-test contrast
P5	Run the compliance checklist (file name and type; zero school identifiers in slides, template or metadata; slide numbers; appendix map); execute the 10-minute AI Q&A routine with the strategist	Same, plus rehearse driving appendices with the provided wireless keyboard and mouse so discussion navigation is instant
P6	Save to the provided USB, open it from the stick to verify, keep a backup copy	Same, for both deck and brief

Pre-competition drills. (1) 15-minute research sprint with a complete source log. (2) Chart-in-five-minutes: case table to clean exhibit. (3) Deck-merge drill: four people's slides into one consistent deck in 20 minutes. (4) Appendix navigation: any called number on screen within five seconds. (5) Full AI-operator run of the SOP on a past case. (6) Compliance-check speed run.

Failure modes and countermeasures.

- **Research rabbit holes.** → Every sprint is timeboxed at 15 minutes; the strategist can call "park it".
- **Deck-merge crunch at the end.** → Rolling merge from the start of P4; slide owners deliver inside the template, never in loose files.
- **An unsourced factoid reaches a slide.** → The source log is mandatory; the verification rules below are enforced at P5 — no exceptions for "I saw it somewhere".
- **Tech failure at handover.** → Save to USB early, verify it opens, keep a second copy; know the fixed pickup time cold; never rename files after the compliance check.

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4. General-business strategist

Mission. Own the argument and the clock. Integrate the three specialists into one storyline covering every rubric row — above all *Implementation & resources* (2.5×, the single heaviest category), plus *Framing the problem*, *Impact*, and *Measurement, risks & mitigation*. Timekeeper during prep, marshal during Q&A.

Owned artifacts per round.

Round	Artifacts
Prepared (25 %)	Problem framing and storyboard; executive summary; implementation roadmap with owners, timeline, resources; risk and KPI slide; Q&A grid; speaker allocation (every member must speak)
Boardroom (30 %)	The one-page executive brief (drafting owner); protected-3-minute script; summary-slide layout; risk/measurement appendix; discussion battle plan assigning question themes so every member speaks
Traditional (45 %)	Framing slide; storyline; implementation plan; KPI/risk slide; Q&A grid; timing plan for 20 + 10
Final	Q&A grid v2; timing plan for the 20 + 15 format with a fresh judge panel

Minute-map.

Phase	Traditional (3 h)	Boardroom (4 h)
P1	Read top-down for the decision-maker's actual question; draft problem statement and success criteria	Same
P2	Chair the timeboxed direction decision; lock the one-sentence recommendation; assign slide ownership; post the clock plan	Same, plus sketch the brief skeleton
P3	Build the implementation skeleton (phases, owners, resources, timeline) in parallel; mid-sprint thesis check at halfway	Same, with more depth on resourcing and sequencing
P4	Write the exec summary; sequence the deck into the storyline; draft the KPI/risk slide; enforce gate times	Finish the one-page brief early — judges read it before we enter — then the 3-minute script
P5	Run the rehearsal: opening, transitions, card discipline; allocate Q&A themes; run the 10-minute AI routine with the CS lead	Drill the protected 3 minutes to ≤2:45 against the 1-minute red card; then a mock stretch of the discussion

Phase	Traditional (3 h)	Boardroom (4 h)
P6	Final storyline read; confirm every rubric row has a home slide	Same, brief included

Pre-competition drills. (1) Weekly 3-minute pitch on one summary slide. (2) Brief-writing drill: one black-and-white page from a past case in 40 minutes. (3) Implementation-plan drill: any recommendation to a resourced 90-day/12-month plan in 20 minutes. (4) Q&A marshaling against a coach-led panel. (5) Timekeeping a full mock under the card protocol.

Failure modes and countermeasures.

- **Storyline as afterthought.** → Paper storyboard exists by the end of P2; slides fit the story, never the reverse.
- **Thin implementation slide in the 2.5× category.** → Hard minimum: phases, owners, budget line from finance, timeline, first-90-days detail, KPIs.
- **Running over time.** → Rehearse to 90 % of allotted time; when tight, the strategist cuts content — nobody speeds up delivery.
- **Q&A chaos.** → Marshal protocol: each question is routed to exactly one owner; others add only on a hand signal.

GenAI standard operating procedure

The rules explicitly allow internet during timed prep, including university databases, file sharing and generative AI. Our stance: AI is a fifth analyst with zero accountability — fast, occasionally wrong, and never the one answering judges. It checks, stresses and polishes our work; it never does our thinking.

Operating lanes — who prompts, for what. Default is a **single-operator model**: the CS & analytics lead runs the team's AI lane, so we never have four chat sessions producing conflicting output. Three narrow personal lanes exist:

- **Finance lead:** arithmetic and formula verification of the finance lead's own model outputs ("recompute this payback from these inputs").
- **Innovation lead:** counterargument generation against the chosen concept, in P5 only.
- **Strategist:** wording polish for the executive summary and one-page brief in P4, and the Q&A-anticipation routine in P5.

Sanctioned tasks: checking math; stress-testing the recommendation ("argue against this as a skeptical CFO"); generating counterarguments and likely judge questions; polishing exec-summary and headline wording; condensing text to fit the one-page brief; scouting public benchmarks *for verification at source*; formatting clean-up. **Never outsourced:** the problem framing, the option choice, and the core recommendation are made by the four of us. If an AI critique makes us want to change course, that is a team decision the strategist chairs — AI input is one voice, not a verdict.

Verification rules — no unverified number reaches a slide.

1. Every externally sourced figure needs a primary source in the source log (case exhibit, filing, official statistic, reputable database). An AI answer is never a source and is never cited.
2. Finance independently recomputes any AI-checked math once; on disagreement, finance's own calculation stands pending a source check.
3. External benchmarks need two independent sources, or they are relabeled as assumptions with a stated basis.
4. After the P6 number freeze, no new AI-derived content of any kind enters deck, brief or talk track.
5. Anything that cannot be verified in the time available becomes a clearly labeled assumption — or it is cut.

Confidentiality cautions. The cases are confidential: no reproduction, sharing, or discussion outside the competition context. Therefore: never paste the case PDF, its exhibits, or long verbatim extracts into consumer AI tools — assume anything pasted may be retained. Prefer university-licensed or enterprise tools with contractual no-training/zero-retention terms, configured and login-tested before we fly. Prompt by paraphrase and abstraction — our own words, minimum necessary detail ("a regional credit union wants members under 30"), never client-identifiable case language. Keep our school name out of every prompt and visible screen (anonymity is a disqualification rule), and never use any tool to contact anyone — outside contact is banned

after release. Before February: **read the 2027 event guide for any new AI clauses** (the 2025 baseline simply allows GenAI) and ask the organizers (aspercasecomps@umanitoba.ca) whether 2027 adds tool restrictions, disclosure duties, or AI-specific confidentiality rules — this sits on our open-questions list.

The 10-minute AI-assisted Q&A-anticipation routine (P5; strategist + CS lead at one screen):

Minutes	Step
0:00–2:00	Strategist dictates a paraphrased brief — recommendation, three key numbers, main risk. No case text is pasted.
2:00–4:30	Prompt 1: "You are a skeptical judging panel (CFO, COO, marketing executive). Ask the 15 hardest questions about this recommendation, ordered by likelihood." Steer toward implementation and resources first — the heaviest rubric line.
4:30–6:00	Prompt 2: "Which three of these would this team struggle with most, and why?"
6:00–8:30	Team huddle: every question gets an owner and a one-line answer on the Q&A grid; finance verifies any number used in an answer.
8:30–10:00	Strategist scripts bridges for the two weakest spots ("we would validate that in the pilot's first 30 days — the decision does not hinge on it"), then closes the lane. AI output never appears on a slide.

Prep-room kit checklist (one page)

Hardware

☐ 4 laptops (one per student is the maximum), fully charged, + 4 chargers
☐ EU-to-North-America plug adapters (Type A/B) ×4; compact power strip with EU inlet
☐ Mice ×4; USB-A adapter/hub per laptop (the deck is handed over on a provided USB stick)
☐ Own backup USB sticks; simple wristwatch or travel clock (phones and smartwatches banned in prep); earplugs

Files — built before the competition (prebuilt own templates allowed; third-party templates banned for the prepared case)

☐ Neutral slide template with zero school identifiers — no logos, names, colors or file metadata (identifying our school = disqualification)
☐ Finance model shells: market sizing, option economics, implementation budget, sensitivity
☐ One-page brief skeleton, black-and-white, print-tested
☐ Assumptions-register, source-log, Q&A-grid and appendix-map templates
☐ Phase-clock cards for the 3-hour and 4-hour preps; rubric card with weights (2.5 / 2.0 / 2.0 / 1.0 / 1.0 / 1.0 / 1.0)
☐ Offline copies of frameworks and past ABCC cases; tested logins for university databases and the licensed AI tool

Paper and stationery

☐ Printed phase clocks, rubric card, GenAI SOP card, compliance checklist
☐ Sticky notes, index cards, markers, pens, blank paper for storyboarding
☐ Physical calculator

Compliance card — tape it to the table

☐ English only; **.pptx only**; exact file names per the guide ("[Team Name] Prepared Case", "[Team Name] Boardroom Case", "[Team Name] Traditional Case")
☐ No coach or outside contact after case release; no phones or smartwatches in prep
☐ Never name the school — anywhere, to anyone, on any slide or screen
☐ Know the fixed USB pickup time; save, verify, back up well before it
☐ Arrive early — late arrival earns no extra prep or presentation time
☐ Cards at 5 minutes (yellow) and 1 minute (red) — rehearse to finish early

Body and climate

☐ Water and snacks for the prep room; business professional attire ready for presentation slots